

XYZ Technologies — Employee Policy Handbook

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Company: XYZ Technologies

Purpose of this document: This is a fictional company-policy document created specifically for learning an AI/RAG application. It is designed to provide enough structured information for practicing document loading, PDF parsing, chunking, embeddings, vector databases, semantic search, Top-K retrieval, RAG, LLMs, LangChain, LangGraph, evaluation, and FastAPI.

Important: This document is fictional and must not be treated as real HR, legal, security, privacy, or employment advice.

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1. Company Overview

XYZ Technologies is a fictional software company that develops cloud applications, data platforms, artificial intelligence solutions, and digital services.

The company has teams working in:

- Engineering
- Data Engineering
- Data Analytics
- Artificial Intelligence
- Product Management
- Finance
- People Operations
- Sales
- Customer Support
- Information Security
- Cloud Infrastructure

XYZ Technologies operates with a focus on:

- Customer satisfaction
- Security
- Privacy
- Responsible use of technology
- Continuous learning
- Quality
- Collaboration
- Innovation
- Accountability

Employees are expected to follow company policies and procedures applicable to their role.

2. Working Hours and Attendance

2.1 Standard Working Hours

The standard working schedule is:

Monday to Friday, 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM

The standard schedule includes a one-hour meal break.

Certain teams may have different working schedules because of:

- Customer support requirements
- International teams
- Production operations
- Project requirements
- Business continuity
- Manager-approved flexible schedules

2.2 Attendance

Employees should inform their manager as early as possible when they are unable to attend work.

Attendance should be recorded through the approved employee system.

Employees should not mark themselves as present when they are not working.

2.3 Flexible Working Hours

Flexible working hours may be permitted with manager approval.

Employees using flexible schedules must:

1. Complete their assigned work.
 2. Attend required meetings.
 3. Remain available during agreed collaboration hours.
 4. Meet customer commitments.
 5. Follow team communication requirements.
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3. Leave Policy

3.1 Annual Leave

Employees receive:

20 days of annual paid leave per calendar year.

Annual leave should normally be requested through the employee portal at least:

3 working days before the planned absence.

Employees should wait for manager approval before treating a leave request as approved.

Submitting a leave request does not automatically mean that the leave has been approved.

3.2 Sick Leave

Employees receive:

12 days of sick leave per calendar year.

An employee who cannot work because of illness should inform their manager as soon as practical.

The company may request appropriate documentation when required by company procedures.

3.3 Company Holidays

Employees receive:

10 company holidays per year.

The official holiday calendar is published by People Operations before the beginning of each calendar year.

3.4 Emergency Leave

Emergency situations should be communicated to the employee's manager as soon as reasonably possible.

Managers may consider emergency circumstances when reviewing leave requests.

3.5 Leave Approval

Leave approval depends on:

- Business requirements
- Team availability
- Customer commitments
- Project deadlines
- Employee circumstances
- Manager approval

4. Remote and Hybrid Work

4.1 Remote Work

Remote work is permitted for eligible roles when approved by the employee's manager.

Employees working remotely must:

- Maintain a reliable internet connection.
- Protect company information.
- Use approved company devices where required.
- Follow information-security policies.
- Remain available during agreed working hours.
- Attend required meetings.

4.2 Public Computers

Employees must not use public or shared computers to access confidential company systems.

Examples include computers in:

- Internet cafés
- Public libraries
- Hotel business centers
- Shared public workstations

4.3 Remote Security

Employees working remotely should use approved security controls.

Employees should avoid accessing confidential information over unsecured public networks unless an approved security mechanism is being used.

5. Information Security

5.1 Passwords

Employees must use unique passwords for company systems.

Passwords must not be:

- Shared with colleagues
- Written in public locations
- Stored in unsecured documents
- Sent through normal email
- Hard-coded into application source code

5.2 Multi-Factor Authentication

Employees must use multi-factor authentication when it is required or provided for a company system.

5.3 Confidential Information

Confidential information includes, but is not limited to:

- Customer information
- Employee information
- Financial information

- Proprietary source code
- Internal architecture
- Credentials
- API keys
- Security information
- Internal business plans

Confidential information must be stored only in approved company systems.

5.4 Security Incidents

Employees must immediately report suspected security incidents to the Security team.

Examples include:

- Phishing emails
- Lost company devices
- Exposed passwords
- Exposed API keys
- Unauthorized access
- Accidental disclosure of confidential information
- Suspicious downloads

5.5 Least Privilege

Access to company systems should follow the principle of least privilege.

Employees should receive only the access required to perform their responsibilities.

6. Data and Privacy

6.1 Personal Information

Personal information should be collected and used only for legitimate business purposes.

Teams should minimize the amount of personal information they collect.

6.2 Customer Data

Customer information must be handled only through approved systems.

Customer data must not be copied into:

- Personal email
- Personal cloud storage

- Personal messaging applications
- Unapproved AI systems
- Unapproved file-sharing services

6.3 Employee Data

Employee information must be accessible only to authorized personnel.

Sensitive employee information should not be shared with employees who do not have a business requirement to access it.

6.4 Data Retention

Data should be retained only for the period required by the applicable business or legal requirement.

When information is no longer required, it should be securely deleted according to the applicable procedure.

7. Responsible AI and Generative AI

7.1 Approved AI Tools

Employees may use approved generative AI tools for permitted business activities.

Examples of permitted activities may include:

- Brainstorming
- Drafting non-confidential content
- Code explanation
- Learning
- Summarization of approved documents
- Creating test examples

7.2 Prohibited Information

Employees must not enter the following information into an unapproved AI service:

- Confidential company information
- Customer information
- Personal information
- Passwords
- API keys
- Private tokens
- Proprietary source code

- Financially sensitive information
- Security credentials

7.3 Human Review

AI-generated content must be reviewed by a human before it is used for:

- Customer-facing communication
- Legal decisions
- Financial decisions
- Employment decisions
- Security decisions
- Other high-impact business decisions

7.4 AI Hallucinations

AI systems can generate information that appears convincing but is incorrect.

Employees must therefore verify important AI-generated information against reliable sources.

An AI system must not be treated as automatically correct.

7.5 AI Application Evaluation

Teams developing AI applications should evaluate:

- Accuracy
- Relevance
- Hallucination risk
- Retrieval quality
- Privacy
- Security
- Bias
- Failure cases
- Response time
- Reliability

7.6 Retrieval-Augmented Generation

RAG applications should use approved information sources.

Where appropriate, RAG applications should provide source references or citations so users can verify the information used to generate an answer.

8. Internal Knowledge Assistant

8.1 Purpose

XYZ Technologies maintains a fictional internal knowledge assistant that helps employees find information from approved company documents.

Employees can ask questions such as:

"How many annual leave days are available?"

The system retrieves relevant information from approved documents and provides the information to a language model.

8.2 RAG Architecture

The internal assistant uses a retrieval-augmented generation architecture.

The basic process is:

Document → Chunking → Embedding → Vector Database → Retrieval → LLM → Answer

Documents are divided into smaller pieces called chunks.

Each chunk can be converted into an embedding.

Embeddings represent the semantic meaning of text as numerical vectors.

A vector database can store and search these vectors.

The system retrieves relevant chunks when a user asks a question.

The retrieved information is then provided to the language model as context.

8.3 Vector Database

The fictional assistant may use a vector database such as Pinecone to store and search vector representations.

The vector database can store information such as:

- Vector embeddings
- Document identifiers
- Chunk identifiers
- Section names
- Access metadata
- Source information

8.4 Semantic Search

The assistant uses semantic search to find information based on meaning rather than requiring an exact keyword match.

For example, the question:

"How much vacation can I take?"

may retrieve a section containing:

"Employees receive 20 days of annual paid leave per calendar year."

even though the words "vacation" and "annual leave" are different.

8.5 Top-K Retrieval

The system may retrieve the top-K most relevant document chunks.

For example:

Top-K = 3

means the system retrieves the three highest-ranked relevant chunks.

8.6 Insufficient Evidence

If the assistant cannot find enough evidence in the approved documents, it should not invent an answer.

Instead, it should communicate that sufficient information was not found.

8.7 Access Control

The assistant must respect document permissions.

A user must not receive information from documents they are not authorized to access.

9. Expense and Travel

9.1 Expense Claims

Employees may claim approved business expenses by submitting receipts through the approved expense system.

Expense claims should normally be submitted within:

30 days of the expense.

9.2 Business Travel

Business travel should be approved before booking.

Employees should use approved travel providers where applicable.

9.3 Flight Class

Economy class is the standard for flights under six hours.

Business class may require additional approval for:

- Longer flights
- Exceptional business requirements
- Medical requirements
- Executive travel

9.4 Non-Reimbursable Expenses

Examples of normally non-reimbursable expenses include:

- Personal purchases
 - Traffic fines
 - Personal entertainment
 - Unapproved upgrades
 - Personal subscriptions
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10. Procurement and Vendors

10.1 Approved Vendors

Employees should use approved vendors for:

- Software
- Cloud services
- Business applications
- AI services
- Data-processing services
- Infrastructure

10.2 New Vendors

New vendors may require review by:

- Procurement
- Security
- Privacy
- Legal
- Architecture
- Finance

depending on the nature of the service.

10.3 AI Vendors

AI APIs, vector databases, cloud AI services, and data-processing platforms may require additional review before being used with company information.

11. Performance and Learning

11.1 Performance

Performance discussions may consider:

- Role expectations
- Business outcomes
- Quality
- Collaboration
- Reliability
- Customer impact
- Responsible behavior

11.2 Learning

Employees are encouraged to continuously improve their technical and professional skills.

Employees working with company information must use approved learning and development environments.

11.3 Technical Projects

Production technical projects should include:

- Documentation
- Testing
- Monitoring
- Security review where applicable

- Identified ownership
 - Deployment procedures
 - Recovery procedures
-

12. Git and Software Development Practices

12.1 Source Code

Company source code must be stored in approved repositories.

12.2 Secrets

The following must never be committed to a Git repository:

- API keys
- Passwords
- Private tokens
- Database credentials
- Cloud credentials
- Authentication secrets

Secrets should be provided through approved environment or secret-management mechanisms.

12.3 Code Review

Changes to production systems should follow the team's approved code-review process.

12.4 Repository Documentation

Production repositories should contain appropriate documentation, such as:

- README
 - Installation instructions
 - Dependency information
 - Configuration instructions
 - Testing instructions
 - Deployment information
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13. Customer Support

13.1 Customer Information

Customer information should be shared only with authorized people.

13.2 Verification

Customer-facing employees should verify important information before communicating account or policy details.

13.3 Escalations

Issues involving the following should be escalated according to the appropriate procedure:

- Security
 - Privacy
 - Payments
 - Account compromise
 - Customer data exposure
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14. Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. How many annual leave days does an employee receive?

Answer: Employees receive 20 days of annual paid leave per calendar year.

Q2. How much sick leave is provided?

Answer: Employees receive 12 days of sick leave per calendar year.

Q3. How early should annual leave normally be requested?

Answer: Annual leave should normally be requested at least 3 working days before the planned absence.

Q4. Is a submitted leave request automatically approved?

Answer: No. Manager confirmation is required.

Q5. Can confidential company information be entered into an unapproved AI tool?

Answer: No. Confidential information must not be entered into an unapproved AI service.

Q6. What should the internal AI assistant do when it cannot find enough information?

Answer: It should state that sufficient evidence was not found rather than inventing an answer.

Q7. Can an API key be committed to Git?

Answer: No. API keys and other credentials must never be committed to a Git repository.

Q8. Can an employee use a public computer to access confidential company systems?

Answer: No. Employees must not use public or shared computers to access confidential company systems.

Q9. Who owns security incidents?

Answer: The Security team owns security incidents and related security concerns.

Q10. Who owns employee leave policies?

Answer: People Operations owns leave and attendance policies.

Q11. Who owns vendor onboarding?

Answer: Procurement owns vendor onboarding, with additional reviews when required.

Q12. What is the standard working schedule?

Answer: The standard schedule is Monday to Friday, 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM, including a one-hour meal break.

15. Policy Decision Scenarios

Scenario 1 — Customer Data and AI

An employee wants to copy a customer dataset into a public AI chatbot to summarize it.

Decision: The employee must not do this unless the AI service and the proposed data use are explicitly approved.

Relevant policies: Data and Privacy; Responsible AI and Generative AI.

Scenario 2 — Missing RAG Information

An employee asks the internal AI assistant:

"What is the company's parental leave policy?"

The indexed documents do not contain information about parental leave.

Decision: The assistant should say that sufficient evidence was not found. It should not invent a parental leave policy.

Relevant policies: Internal Knowledge Assistant; Responsible AI.

Scenario 3 — API Key Accidentally Committed

A developer accidentally commits an API key to a Git repository.

Decision: The developer must report the incident immediately. The exposed credential should be revoked or rotated according to the Security team's incident procedure.

Relevant policies: Information Security; Git and Software Development Practices.

Scenario 4 — Late Leave Request

An employee submits annual leave one day before the planned absence.

Decision: The normal expectation is three working days' notice. The manager may still consider the request depending on circumstances and business coverage.

Relevant policy: Leave Policy.

Scenario 5 — Remote Employee

An employee working remotely wants to use a computer in an internet café to access confidential company systems.

Decision: This is not permitted.

Relevant policy: Remote and Hybrid Work.

Scenario 6 — AI-Generated Customer Response

An AI assistant generates an answer that will be sent to a customer.

Decision: The response must be reviewed by a human before being used for customer-facing communication.

Relevant policy: Responsible AI and Generative AI.

16. Policy Owners and Contacts

People Operations

Responsible for:

- Leave
- Attendance
- Performance
- General employee policies

Security Team

Responsible for:

- Security incidents
- Phishing
- Credential exposure
- Access-control concerns
- Security investigations

Privacy / Legal

Responsible for:

- Personal information
- Privacy requirements

- Regulatory questions
- Privacy-sensitive processing

Engineering / Architecture

Responsible for:

- Technical standards
- APIs
- Cloud services
- AI application architecture
- Production technical systems

Procurement

Responsible for:

- Vendor onboarding
- Purchasing
- Approved suppliers

17. Document Control

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